

APPOINTMENTS

London School of Economics and Political Science	London, UK
Associate Professor	2024 –Present
Assistant Professor	2019 –2024
Washington University in St Louis	St Louis, MO, USA
Assistant Professor	2017 –2019

EDUCATION

University of California, Los Angeles	Los Angeles, USA
Ph.D. in Political Science	2011 –2017
University of Oxford	Oxford, UK
M.S. in African Studies	2008 –2009
University of Oxford	Oxford, UK
B.A. (Hons.) Philosophy, Politics and Economics	2005–2008

PUBLICATIONS

Book

- [1] **Sarah Brierley**. *The Co-opted State: How Politicians' Control Over Bureaucrats' Careers Threatens Governance*. Political Economy of Institutions and Decisions. Cambridge University Press, 2026.

Journal Articles

- [1] **Sarah Brierley**, Noah L. Nathan, George Oforu, and Tingxuan Zhu. "The Seeds of State Capture: Merit and Patrimonialism in the Colonial Bureaucracy". In: *American Political Science Review* (2026). Conditionally accepted.
- [2] **Sarah Brierley** and George Kwaku Oforu. "Chiefs' endorsements and voter behavior". In: *Comparative Political Studies* 57.10 (2024), pp. 1703–1734.
- [3] **Sarah Brierley**, Kenneth Lowande, Rachel Augustine Potter, and Guillermo Toral. "Bureaucratic politics: Blind spots and opportunities in political science". In: *Annual Review of Political Science* 26.1 (2023), pp. 271–290.
- [4] **Sarah Brierley** and Miguel M Pereira. "Women bureaucrats and petty corruption. Experimental evidence from Ghana". In: *Research & Politics* 10.1 (2023).
- [5] **Sarah Brierley** and Noah L Nathan. "Motivating the machine: Which brokers do parties pay?" In: *The Journal of Politics* 84.3 (2022), pp. 1539–1555.
- [6] **Sarah Brierley**. "Combining patronage and merit in public sector recruitment". In: *The Journal of Politics* 83.1 (2021), pp. 182–197.
- [7] **Sarah Brierley** and Noah L Nathan. "The connections of party brokers: Which brokers do parties select?" In: *The Journal of Politics* 83.3 (2021), pp. 884–901.
- [8] **Sarah Brierley**. "Unprincipled Principals: Co-opted Bureaucrats and Corruption in Ghana". In: *American Journal of Political Science* 64.2 (2020), pp. 209–222.
- [9] **Sarah Brierley** and Eric Kramon. "Party campaign strategies in Ghana: Rallies, canvassing and handouts". In: *African Affairs* 119.477 (2020), pp. 587–603.
- [10] **Sarah Brierley**, Eric Kramon, and George Kwaku Oforu. "The moderating effect of debates on political attitudes". In: *American Journal of Political Science* 64.1 (2020), pp. 19–37.

- [11] Joseph Asunka, **Sarah Brierley**, Miriam Golden, Eric Kramon, and George Ofosu. “Electoral fraud or violence: The effect of observers on party manipulation strategies”. In: *British Journal of Political Science* 49.1 (2019), pp. 129–151.
- [12] **Sarah Brierley** and George Ofosu. “The presidential and parliamentary elections in Ghana, December 2012”. In: *Electoral Studies* 35 (2014), pp. 382–385.
- [13] **Sarah Brierley**. “Party unity and presidential dominance: parliamentary development in the fourth republic of Ghana”. In: *Journal of Contemporary African Studies* 30.3 (2012), pp. 419–439.

Other writing

- [1] **Sarah Brierley**. “Reiview of: Patronage at Work: Public Jobs and Political Services in Argentina.” In: *Governance* 38.2 (2025), p. 1.

Working drafts

- [1] **Sarah Brierley**. “Political Finance in Africa”. Book manuscript in progress.
- [2] **Sarah Brierley** and Daniel de Kadt. “Do Voters Want (and Reward) Stricter Political Finance Regulation? Evidence from South Africa”. Under Review.
- [3] **Sarah Brierley** and Mathias Poertner. “Reaching Across the Aisle to Fight Corruption: Cross-Party Anti-Corruption Platforms and Political Engagement”. Preparing for submission.

RESEARCH GRANTS

“Political Finance in Africa” (UKRI Future Leaders Fellowship)	£1.24m (2026)
“Political Party Funding in South Africa” (LSE RISF Fund)	£20,000 (2023)
“Do Endorsements by Traditional Leaders Affect Voter Attitudes?” (LSE Global Challenge Account)	\$25,000 (2020)
International Growth Centre	\$13,500 (2020)
“Social Norms and the Practice of Everyday Corruption in Ghana” (DFID/STAAC via Adam Smith Institute)	\$42,000 (2017)
“Who are the Foot Soldiers? Local Party Intermediaries in Ghana” (with Noah Nathan)	
Weidenbaum Center on the Economy, Government, and Public Policy	\$25,000 (2017)
African Studies Center, University of Michigan	\$3,000 (2017)
“Do Candidate Debates Strengthen Democracy?” (with Eric Kramon, George Ofosu)	
International Growth Centre	£19,996 (2016)
APSA Centennial Center (William A. Steiger Fund)	\$5,000 (2016)
“When does the state deliver? Procurement in Ghana” (with Daniel Posner)	
International Growth Centre	£19,972 (2015)
“The Impact of Domestic Election Observers on Electoral Violence, Integrity, and Voting Behavior” (with Joseph Asunka, Miriam Golden (PI), Eric Kramon, George Ofosu)	
National Science Foundation RAPID (SES-1265247)	\$98,243 (2012)
UK Department for International Development (DFID)	\$115,566 (2012)

TEACHING AND ADVISING

- **Convenor**
Governance and Corruption (GV327)
Philosophy, Politics, and Economics (PPE) Research Project (GV344)
- **Lecturer**
Power and Politics in the Modern World (GV248)
Research Design in the Social Sciences (GV5X1)
- **PhD supervisor**
Godwin Kugblenu (incoming student)
- **PhD second supervisor**
Martin Haus - postdoc (Leibniz University, Hanover)

PRESENTATIONS

Academic Visits and Talks

University of Manchester; University of Reading	2026
University Carlos III of Madrid; Universidad Instituto de Empresa (IE), Madrid	2025
University of Gothenburg; Aix-Marseille University, Marseille	2023
University of Oxford; Nuffield College, University of Oxford; Bocconi University	2022
Universidad Instituto de Empresa (IE) (online); Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México (online)	2021
University College London; University of Gothenburg; Trinity College Dublin; University of Essex; Aarhus University	2020
University College London; University of California, San Diego; Harvard University (Clientelism Workshop)	2019
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign; Juan March Institute / Carlos III University (Political Economy of Corruption Workshop); University of Ghana, Legon; Illinois State University (Institute for Corruption Studies Workshop); University of Ghana (ISSER)	2018
University of Gothenburg (Workshop on Experimental Political Science)	2015
University of Montreal (Voting Experiments Workshop)	2014

Annual Meetings

European Political Science Society:	2026
American Political Science Association:	2014, 2016, 2017, 2023, 2026
Midwest Political Science Association:	2018, 2019
European Political Science Association:	2023, 2025
CBS-Princeton Money in Politics Conference:	2023, 2024

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Departmental Service

Deputy Head of Department (Research)	2025–Present
Member of DSSG Committee	2023–Present
Founder and Chair, Women's Network, Department of Government, LSE	2019–Present
Departmental Ethics Reviewer	2025–Present
Co-Editor, Government Department blog	2025–Present
Chair and Member of EDI Committee	2025–2026
Member of Faculty Hiring Committee	2025–2026
Co-chair, African Political Economy Group Seminar	2019–2024
EDI Committee Member	2023–2024
EDI Committee Member	2022–2023
EDI Committee Member	2021–2022
HoD Search Committee	2022
Doctoral Program Committee	2022–2023
Doctoral Program Committee	2020–2021
Doctoral Program Committee	2019–2020
Faculty Search Committee, Washington University in St. Louis	2018–2019

Conference Service

Section Chair, Bureaucratic Politics Section, MPSA	2026
Co-organiser, London Politics of Global South annual conference	2023
Section Chair, African Politics Section, MPSA	2019
Section Chair, Experimental Research Division, APSA	2018

Award Committees

Pi Sigma Alpha Undergraduate Research Award (MPSA)	2026
APCG–African Affairs Best Graduate Student Paper Award	2024

Journal and Book Refereeing

African Affairs, American Journal of Political Science, American Political Science Review, British Journal of Political Science, Cambridge University Press, Comparative Political Studies, Comparative Politics, Democratization, Development Studies Research, Electoral Studies, European Political Science Review, Ghana Studies, Journal of Development Studies, Journal of Experimental Political Science, Journal of Modern African Studies, Journal of Peace Research, Journal of Policy Analysis and Management, Journal of Politics, Journal of Public Economics, Journal of Public Policy, Party Politics, Palgrave, Political Research Quarterly, Research and Politics, Review of Economics and Political Science, Routledge, SAGE Open, World Development.

Last updated: June 2026